Design System & UX

polycarpic — personal budgeting & wealth management (virtual Single Family Office)

Owner: `ux-designer` agent **Status:** Draft — Plan phase, matured alongside ARCH **Version:** 0.12

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1. Overview & Design Principles

What this product should feel like to use, and the principles that resolve design disputes.

- **Mobile-first when in doubt.** The primary v1 target is a self-hosted web dashboard used on desktop for deep review (statements, lot tables) and on mobile for quick checks (dashboard glance, confirming a draft transaction) — design the dense screens up from a mobile layout, not down from desktop.
- **Accessible by default (WCAG AA).** Non-negotiable per PRD §6. Financial gain/loss and status signals never rely on color alone — see Financial semantics.
- **No decorative loading states.** Skeletons match the real layout; spinners are a last resort (see Component inventory).
- **Every number earns trust.** This is a general ledger, not a budgeting toy — a balance, a delta, or a pending-liability figure must always be traceable to its source (the journal entry, the lot, the reconciliation). The UI never shows a number it can't explain if clicked.
- **Immutability is visible, not just enforced.** A posted transaction reads as posted (badge, disabled edit affordance); a correction reads as a reversal + new entry, never as a silent edit (PRD §5).
- **Diverge from polycarpic's own tooling, deliberately.** The cairn tracker (our internal tool) and the product are not the same thing and shouldn't look like it — this system's identity is derived from **measured** screenshots and live style reads off Monarch Money and Origin (`useorigin.com`), not memory (Principal direction, 2026-09-28) — see Inspiration: Monarch & Origin.
- **One brand hue, used honestly.** The Principal's neon-green brand color (`#2CFF05`, 2026-09-30 — "the project name relates to fruiting plants") measures 1.36:1 against white, far below AA — kept as the literal `--brand` value everywhere it clears AA (dark surfaces), with a darkened same-hue green for light-mode `--primary`, stated plainly rather than silently swapped for a different hue — see Foundations.

2. Design System

The single source of truth for the visual language. The written spec lives alongside this doc; the machine-readable system lives in the two CSS files that `frontend-lead` consumes directly.

- design-system-spec.md § Inspiration — what was taken from Monarch Money and Origin, and why
- design-system-spec.md § shadcn-svelte reuse map *(pass 8, new)* — every component/region mapped to its shadcn-svelte component, block, or a stated "custom" reason
- design-system-spec.md — the written spec (token rationale, financial semantics, component inventory, accessibility)
- tokens.css — design tokens as CSS custom properties (hand-authored palette, not a vendored shadcn preset)
- tokens.html *(pass 6, new)* — every token decoded: name, value in both modes, swatch, one-line "used for"
- screen.css — component & screen styles built on the tokens

Figma stays the high-fidelity design tool for anything shipping pixel-exact (via the `ux-designer`'s Figma skills); `docs/DESIGN/` is the in-repo, code-level home that ships with the project and is the contract for implementation.

3. Design Tokens

Color, typography, spacing, radius, and shadow primitives — SvelteKit + shadcn-svelte (PRD §8). Edit values in tokens.css; the swatches below preview the live variables. Full rationale in design-system-spec.md — or see tokens.html for every token decoded with both-mode values and a "used for" line.

3.1 Surfaces & Text

`--background`	`--foreground`	`--card`	`--popover`	`--muted`	`--muted-foreground`

3.2 Actions & States

`--primary`	`--brand (dark surfaces only — see Foundations)`	`--brand-2 (pass 5, same rule — see Secondary accent)`	`--secondary`	`--accent`	`--destructive`

3.3 Financial semantics (new — polycarpic-specific)

`--positive`	`--warning`	`--destructive (reused for negative/danger)`

See design-system-spec.md § Financial semantics — gain/loss, safe-harbor status tiers, and the "never color alone" rule.

3.4 Borders & Focus

`--border`	`--input`	`--ring`

3.5 Charts (sequential ramp — magnitude, not category; re-hued to --brand-2, pass 10)



`--chart-1` `--chart-2` `--chart-3` `--chart-4` `--chart-5`

3.6 Sidebar (inverted, pass 4; re-hued blue, pass 5)



`--sidebar` `--sidebar-accent` `--sidebar-ring`

Dark-on-light in light mode, light-on-dark in dark mode — see design-system-spec.md § Sidebar for the collapse-to-rail behavior and three proposed expand/collapse cues.

Type: `--font-sans` *Inter — one grotesque sans for body and headings, hierarchy by weight, confirmed against both reference products' actual app UI (their serif accent is marketing-only, see Inspiration);* `--font-mono` *Roboto Mono — Origin's own measured choice, for uppercase eyebrow labels, account numbers, tickers, tabular figures.* ***Radius:*** *measured* `--radius-sm|md|lg|xl` *= 6/8/12/20px (cards 12px, buttons 8px — both products' actual app-level values, not either's marketing-only pill).*

4. Components & Screen Styles

The component inventory and the styles that realize it, built on the tokens. Styles live in screen.css; full states-per-component table lives in design-system-spec.md § Component inventory.

Component	shadcn-svelte primitive	polycarpic usage
Net-worth hero	Chart (LayerChart, Area)	Big figure + signed delta on the figure + single-line area chart — direct Monarch pattern
Grouped account list	Table / custom	Type-grouped rows with sparkline + freshness — direct Monarch pattern
Segmented bar + legend	Custom, tokens-driven	Assets/Liabilities, allocation actual-vs-target — direct Monarch pattern
Badge	Badge	Entity/account/transaction status, link-health — see Financial semantics
Transaction table	Table	Account register, exceptions report, lots
Accordion *(pass 7, new)*	Accordion	Transactions' three urgency-ordered cards (Exceptions/Pending/Posted); Pending row expansion
Near-full-screen modal *(pass 7, new)*	Dialog	Journal-entry modal (header + legs) — manual entry, Correct entry, Split, Group & Summarize
Entity switcher	Tabs / Sidebar	Switch between Person/Trust/Business/Household
Transaction detail	Sheet	Drill into a posted/draft entry, its journal lines, source doc
Empty state	Card + plain text, no skeleton	Dashboard panels not yet shipped (tax at 1.0, allocation at M4) — see styled-screens/dashboard.html

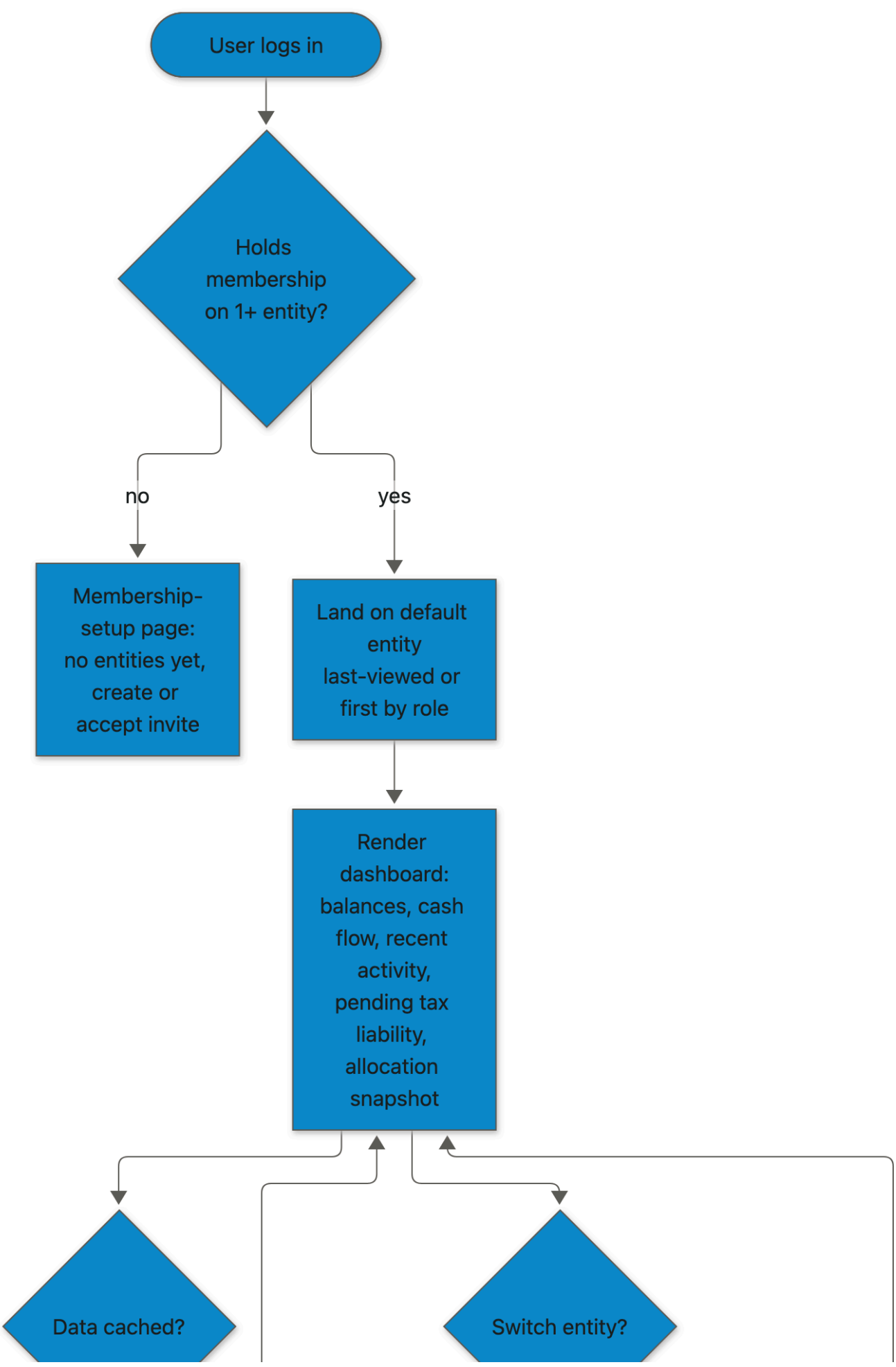
Component	shadcn-svelte primitive	polycarpic usage
Top row *(pass 8, rebuilt; reduced pass 9)*	—, starts right of the sidebar	Not sticky, same background as content (pass 9): panel-left icon + separator + breadcrumb left; entity selector + separator + "more" menu right — AI/search/notifications/gear dropped — see design-system-spec.md § Header
Sidebar *(pass 8, rebuilt; floating card pass 9)*	Sidebar (shadcn-svelte sidebar-07 block)	Floating card, gutter + rounded all 4 corners (pass 9), seven nav items, brand top item, avatar-popover bottom item opening right (pass 9) — see design-system-spec.md § Sidebar
"More" menu *(pass 9, new)*	DropdownMenu	Top row, right-justified — per-page global actions (Sync, New entry, Export, ...)
Avatar cluster *(pass 5, new)*	—, custom	Overlapping initials in the entity selector, max 3 + overflow
Avatar popover *(pass 8, new; opens right + proposed items pass 9)*	Popover / DropdownMenu	User menu at the sidebar's bottom, opens to the right — profile, Settings (proposed), Notifications (proposed), preferences, theme, keyboard shortcuts, Log out last
Public hero *(pass 4, corrected)*	—, custom	Home — pre-auth landing page, product statement + CTAs, not a signed-in screen
Split screen login *(pass 4, refined pass 5)*	—, custom	Login — full field list, centered form column, always-branded visual pane

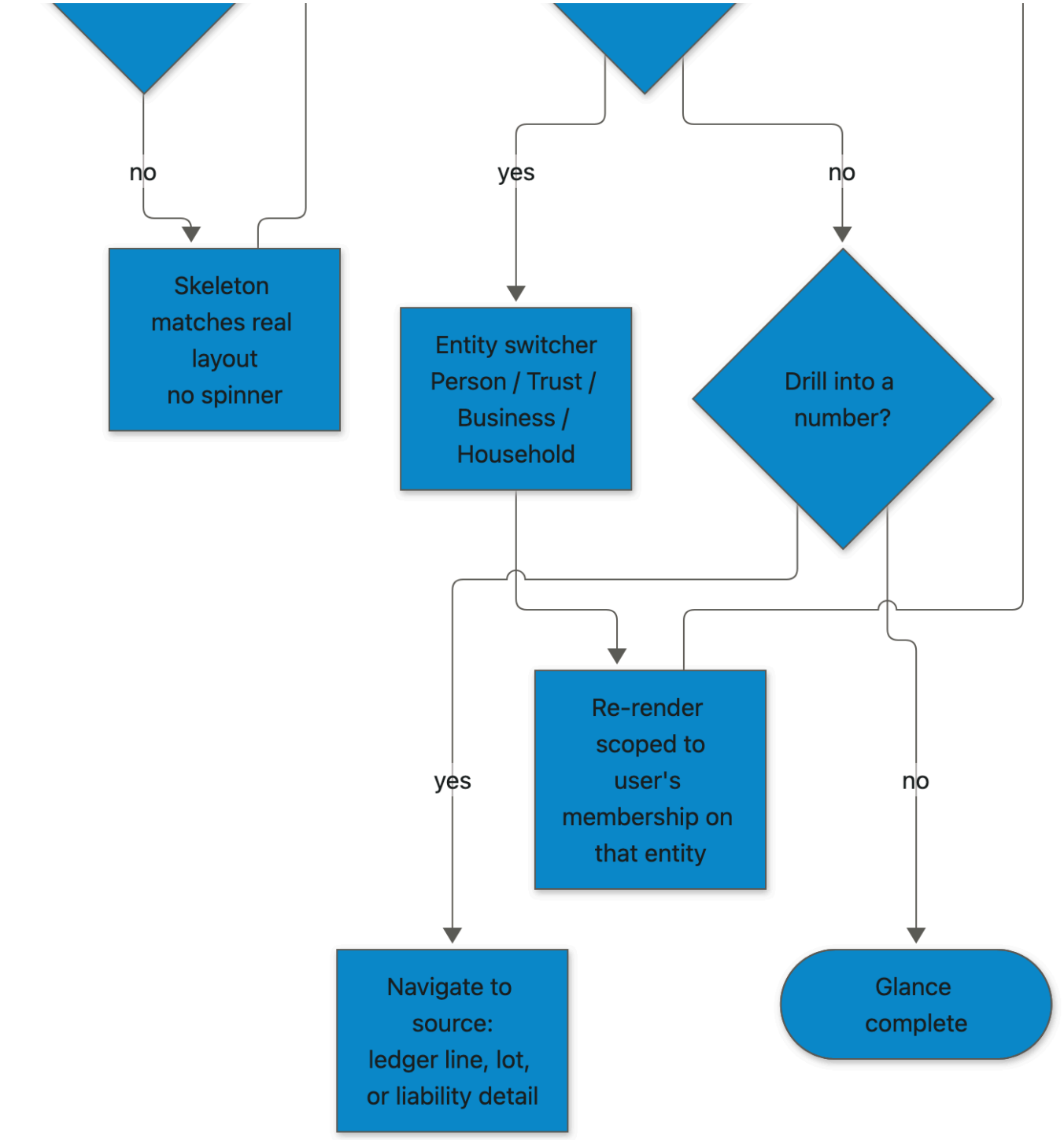
5. User Flows

How users move through the product to accomplish the highest-traffic stories (PRD §4). ***Pass 5 fix (2026-09-30):*** *these previously linked to* `flows/*.md`*, which the browser serves as raw Markdown — the fenced* `mermaid` *blocks never ran through the page's own Mermaid loader, so nothing rendered (not a syntax error, as first suspected). Each flow is now embedded inline below; the* `.md` *files stay as the diffable source of truth in flows/.*

5.1 Dashboard glance

Story (PRD §4.1): *per-entity financial health at a glance. Source: flows/dashboard-glance-flow.md.*


User logs in
Holds membership on 1+ entity?
no
yes
Membership-setup page: no entities yet, create or accept invite
Land on default entity last-viewed or first by role
Render dashboard: balances, cash flow, recent activity, pending tax liability, allocation snapshot
Data cached?
Switch entity?

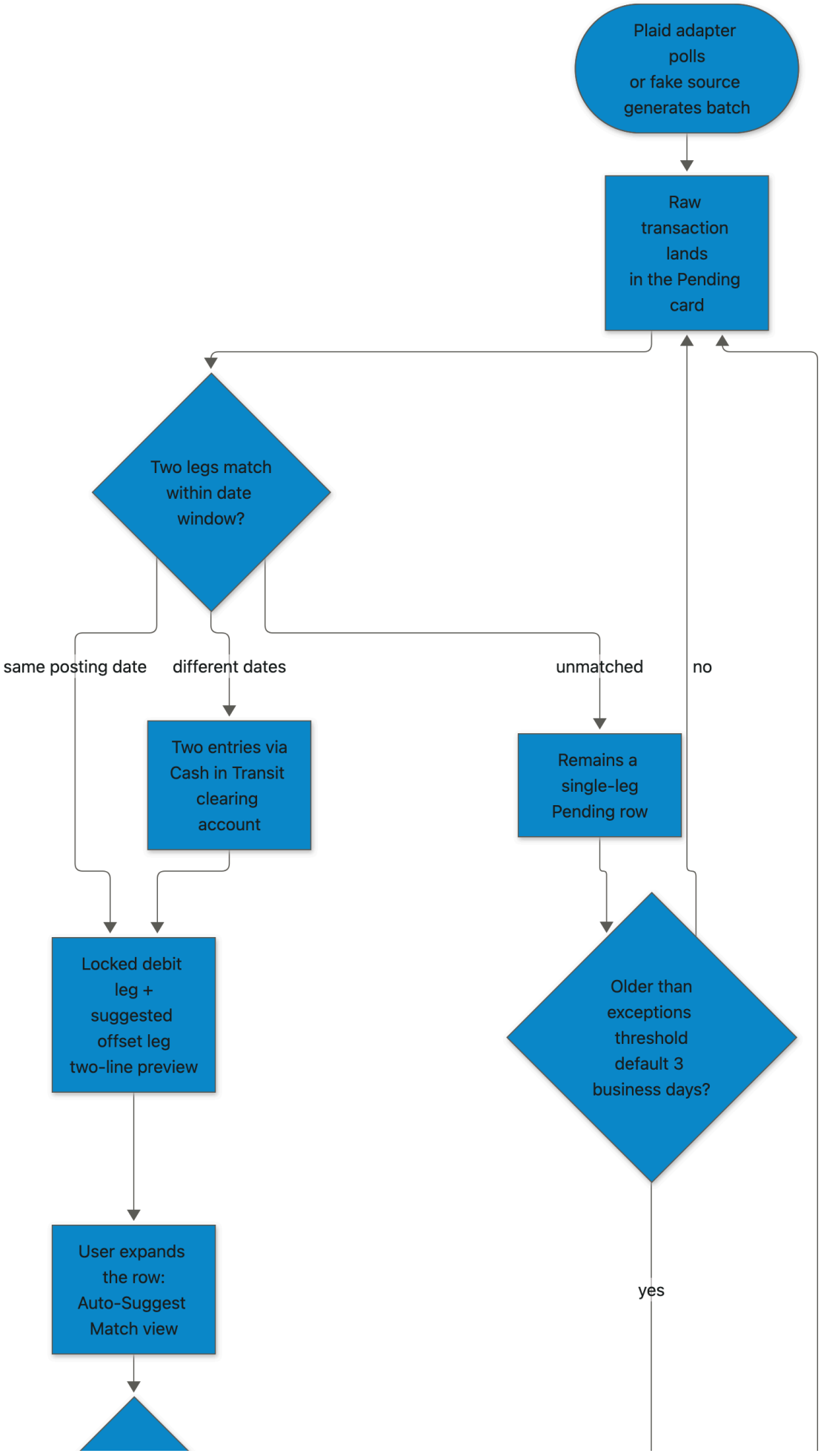


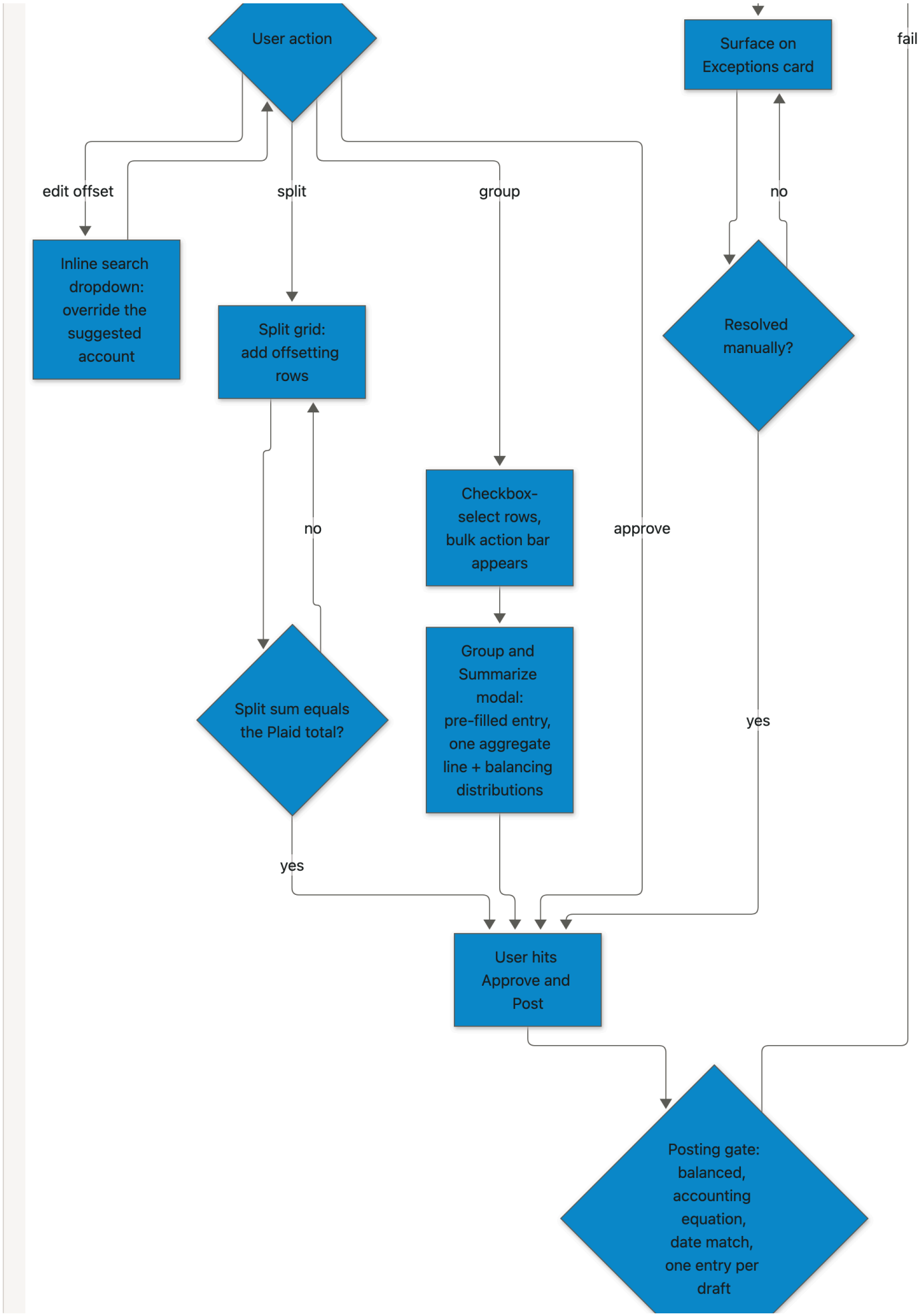
- Every number on this screen must be clickable through to its source (Overview principle: "every number earns trust").
- Filtered strictly by membership (owner/manager/viewer) — no transitive access via parent entity (PRD §5 permission model).
- **No-membership state (pass 6):** see wireframes/membership-setup.html — the Principal confirmed the dashboard's empty state can simply be the membership-setup page itself, not a separate illustrated empty-state screen.

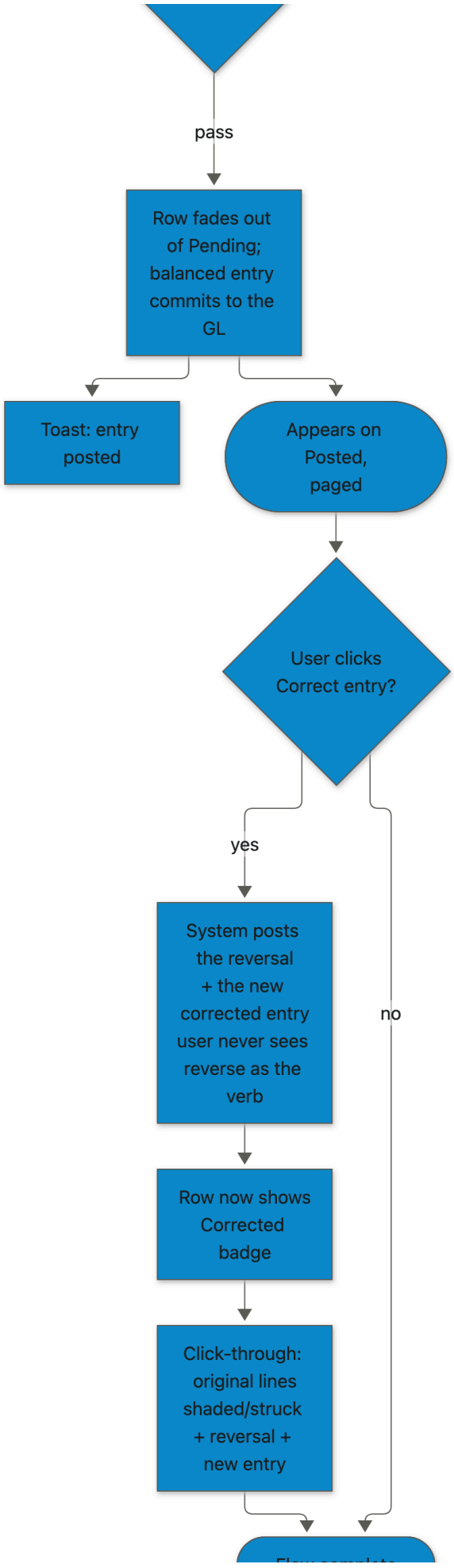
- **"Skeleton matches real layout, no spinner" (pass 6):** while dashboard data is loading, the screen shows placeholder blocks already shaped like the real cards (same card chrome, same approximate text-line widths) instead of a spinner — so nothing visually jumps or re-flows once the real numbers arrive, they just fade in where the placeholders already were.

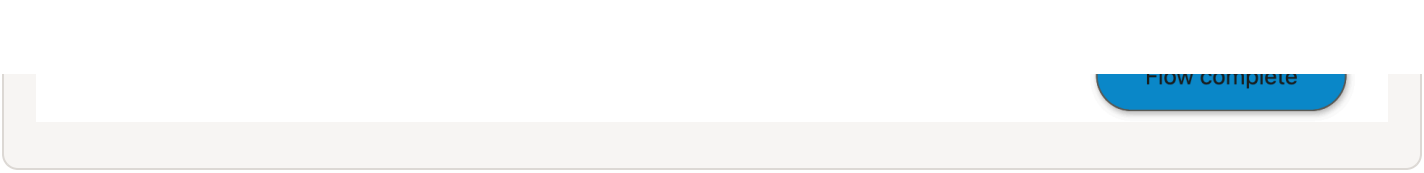
5.2 Transactions — review, match & correct

Story (PRD §4.2): *staged for review → matched/split/grouped → posted → correctable. Source: flows/import-confirm-flow.md.* ***Pass 7 full rewrite:*** *this screen is now* ***Transactions*** *("Ledger"/"Import" renamed/retired) — the review mechanics below are the Principal's own Plaid bank-feed workflow spec.*


Plaid adapter polls or fake source generates batch
Raw transaction lands in the Pending card
Two legs match within date window?
same posting date
different dates
unmatched
no
Two entries via Cash in Transit clearing account
Remains a single-leg Pending row
Locked debit leg + suggested offset leg two-line preview
Older than exceptions threshold default 3 business days?
User expands the row: Auto-Suggest Match view
yes


User action
edit offset
split
group
approve
Inline search dropdown: override the suggested account
Split grid: add offsetting rows
Checkbox-select rows, bulk action bar appears
no
Split sum equals the Plaid total?
Group and Summarize modal: pre-filled entry, one aggregate line + balancing distributions
yes
User hits Approve and Post
Surface on Exceptions card
no
Resolved manually?
yes
fail
Posting gate: balanced, accounting equation, date match, one entry per draft

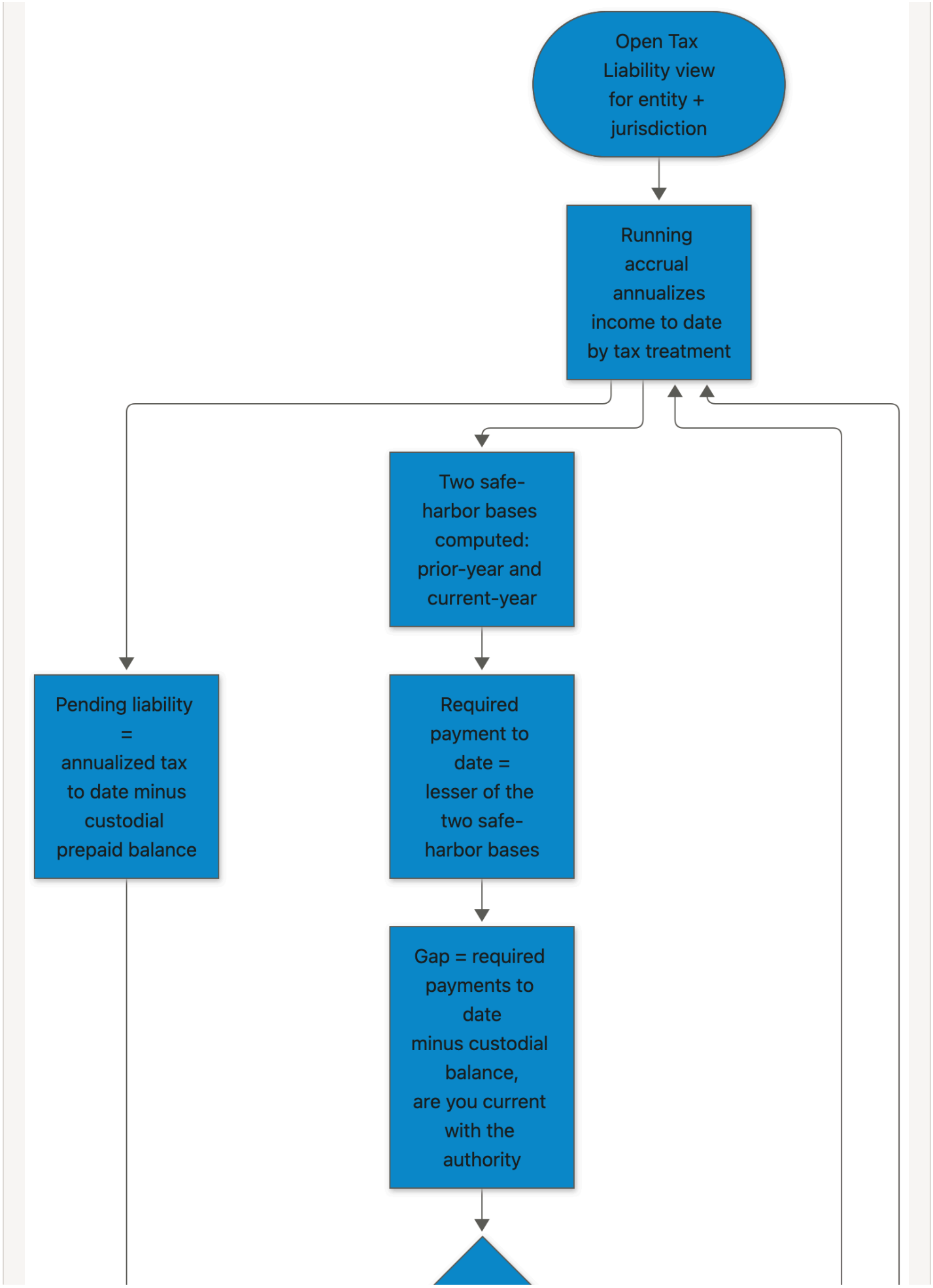

pass
Row fades out of Pending; balanced entry commits to the GL
Toast: entry posted
Appears on Posted, paged
User clicks Correct entry?
yes
no
System posts the reversal + the new corrected entry user never sees reverse as the verb
Row now shows Corrected badge
Click-through: original lines shaded/struck + reversal + new entry

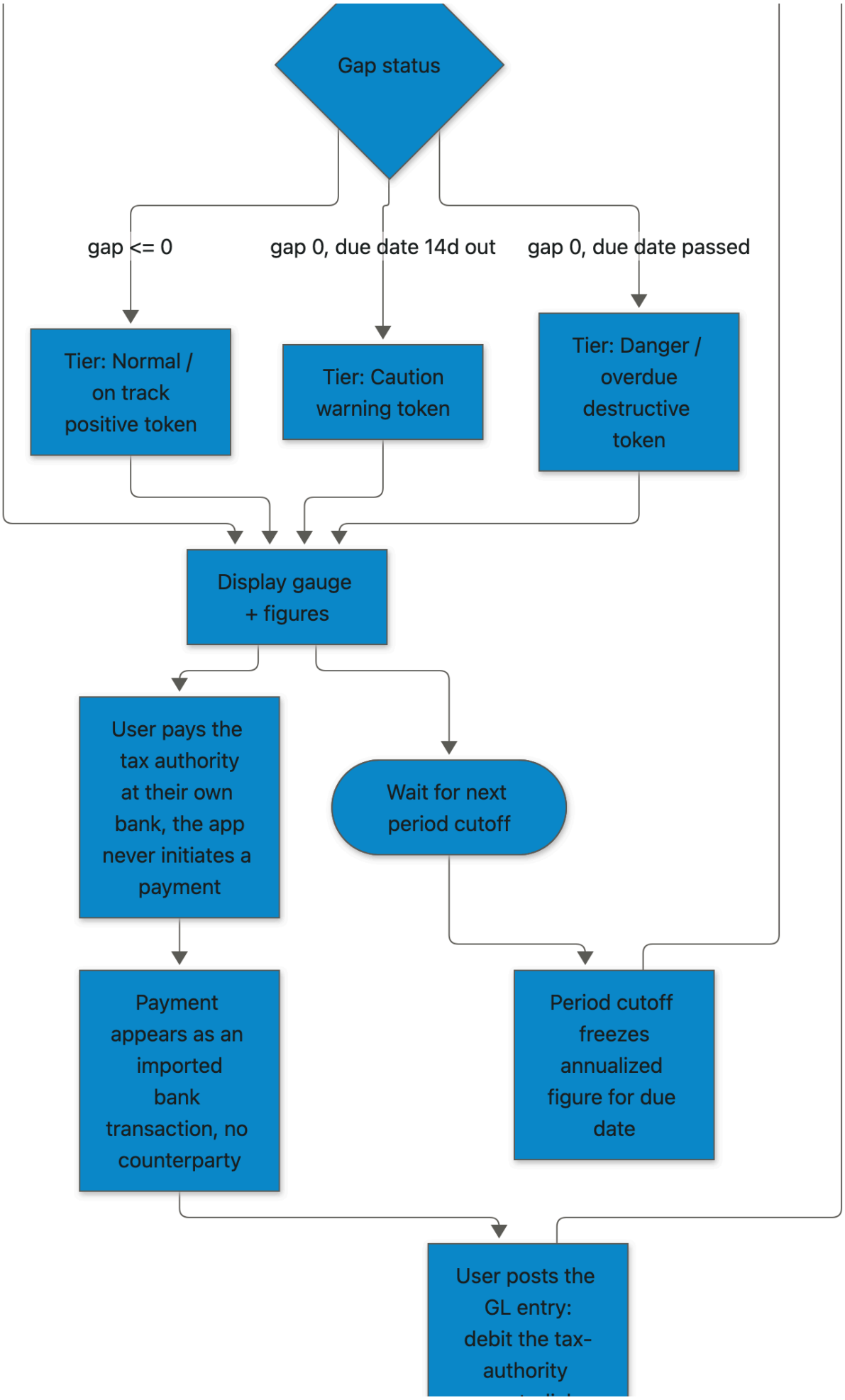


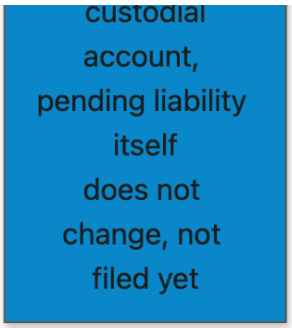
- **The locked leg** is always the custodial cash side (verified bank reality) — never editable, in the preview, Split grid, or Group modal. **The suggested offset leg** is pre-filled from historical rules + Plaid category, overridden in place via an inline search dropdown.
- **Split** is one draft → one multi-leg entry, live-validated to the Plaid total before it's submittable. **Group** is many drafts → one entry (the one many-to-one case, ARCH §3) via the shared journal-entry modal, pre-filled with an aggregate line + balancing distributions.
- **Posting gate:** Σ debits = Σ credits; accounting equation per entity; entry date matches bank date (or the CIT rule); every posted draft linked to exactly one entry — any failure keeps the item in Pending.
- **Reframed pass 6, unchanged:** a posted row's user-facing action is "Correct entry", never "edit"/"reverse" — reversal-only underneath (PRD §5). See design-system-spec.md § Correcting a posted entry.
- A corrected row carries the `Corrected` badge (`--outline` + `--brand-2`-tinted dot, pencil icon); click-through reveals the full double-entry trail — original lines shaded/struck, the reversal, and the new entry. An auto-posted row carries the same badge/action plus a `posted by rule — <name>` line (addendum, pass 6).
- Actor attribution (user / auto-post rule / system job) is shown on every draft and posted row, never inferred (PRD §5).

5.3 Tax liability & safe-harbor

Story (PRD §4.4): *pending liability, required payment, gap, pay. Source: flows/tax-liability-flow.md.*


Open Tax Liability view for entity + jurisdiction
Running accrual annualizes income to date by tax treatment
Two safe-harbor bases computed: prior-year and current-year
Pending liability = annualized tax to date minus custodial prepaid balance
Required payment to date = lesser of the two safe-harbor bases
Gap = required payments to date minus custodial balance, are you current with the authority

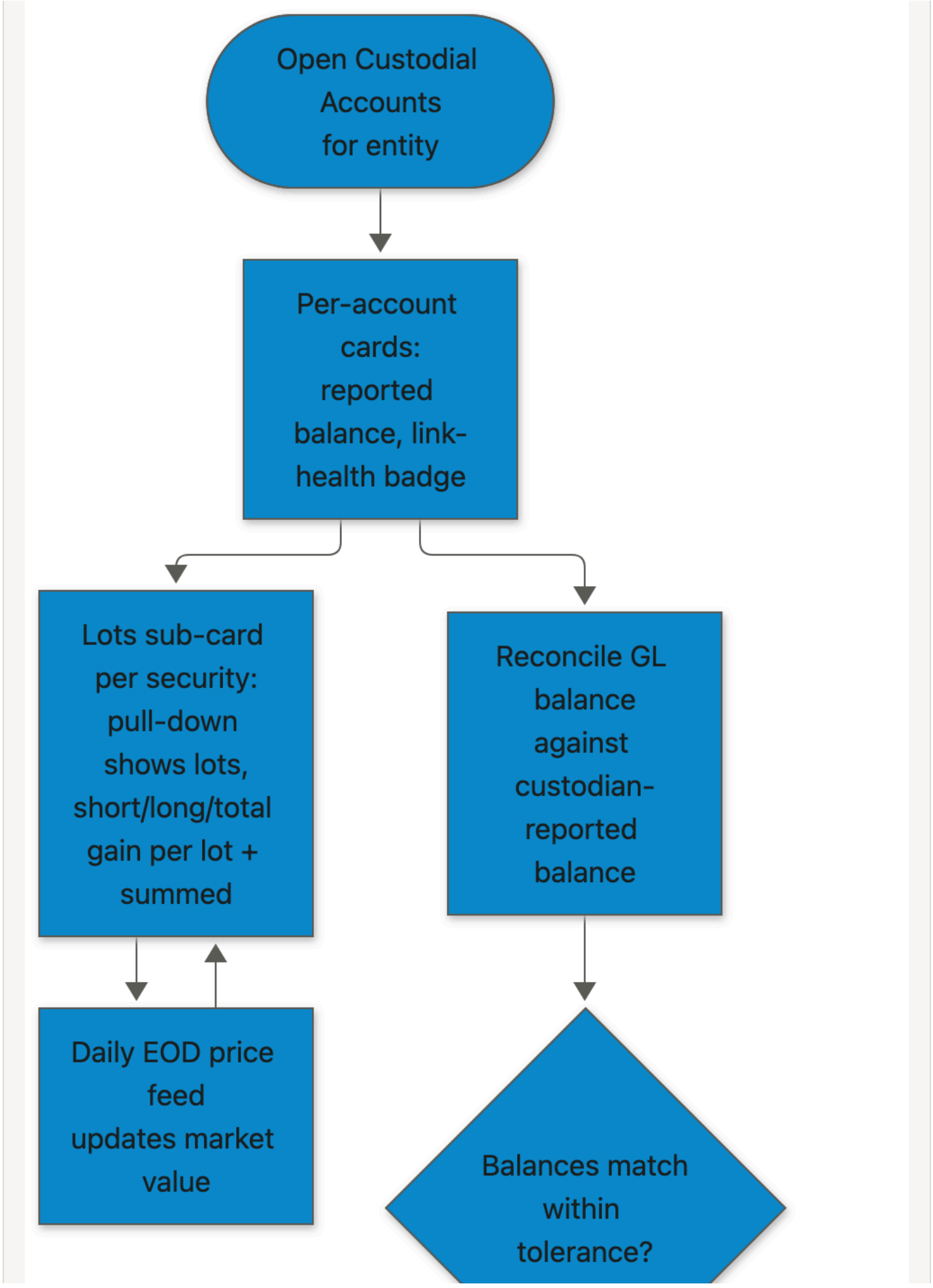

Gap status
gap <= 0
gap 0, due date 14d out
gap 0, due date passed
Tier: Normal / on track positive token
Tier: Caution warning token
Tier: Danger / overdue destructive token
Display gauge + figures
User pays the tax authority at their own bank, the app never initiates a payment
Wait for next period cutoff
Payment appears as an imported bank transaction, no counterparty
Period cutoff freezes annualized figure for due date
User posts the GL entry: debit the tax-authority

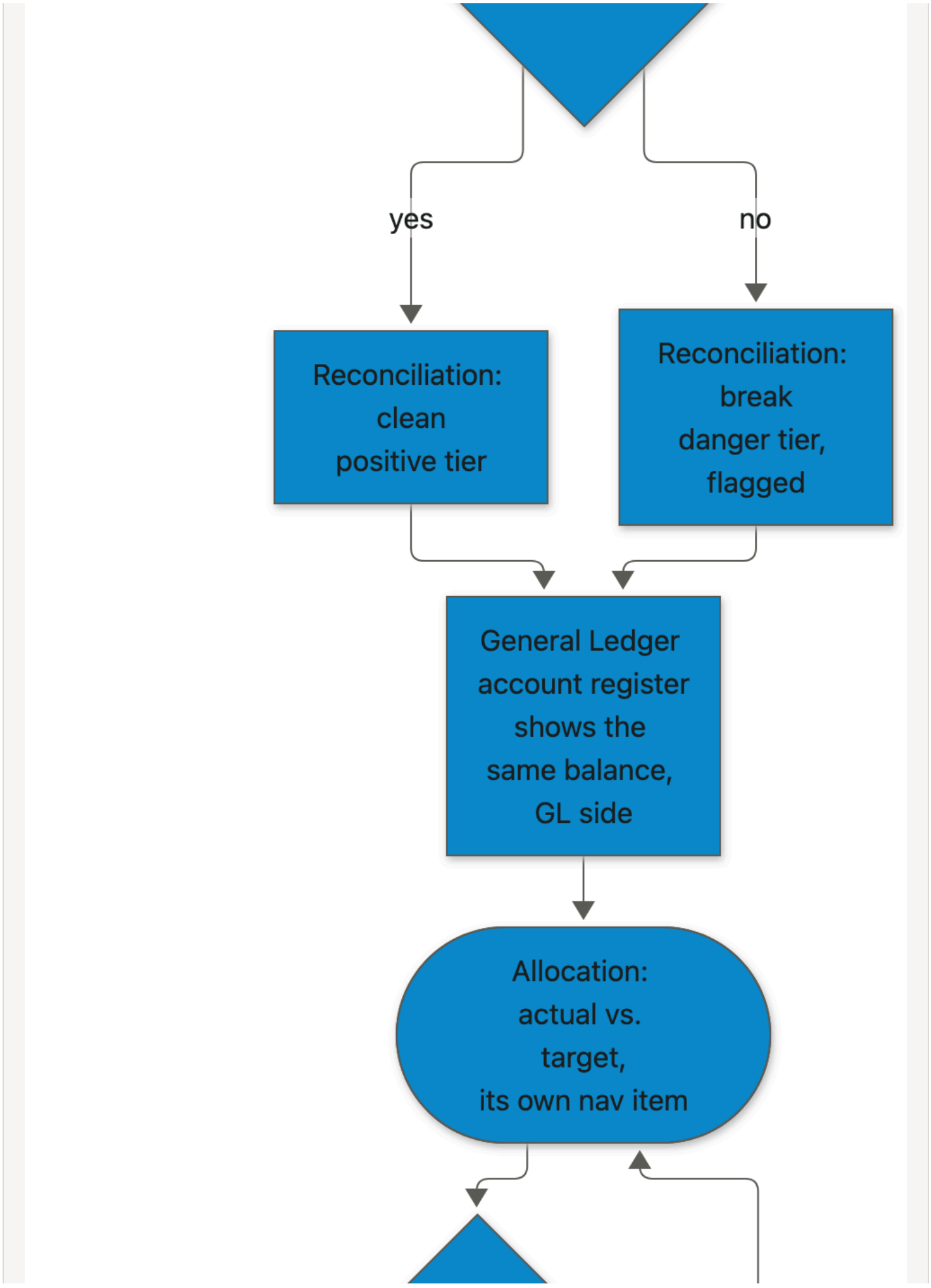


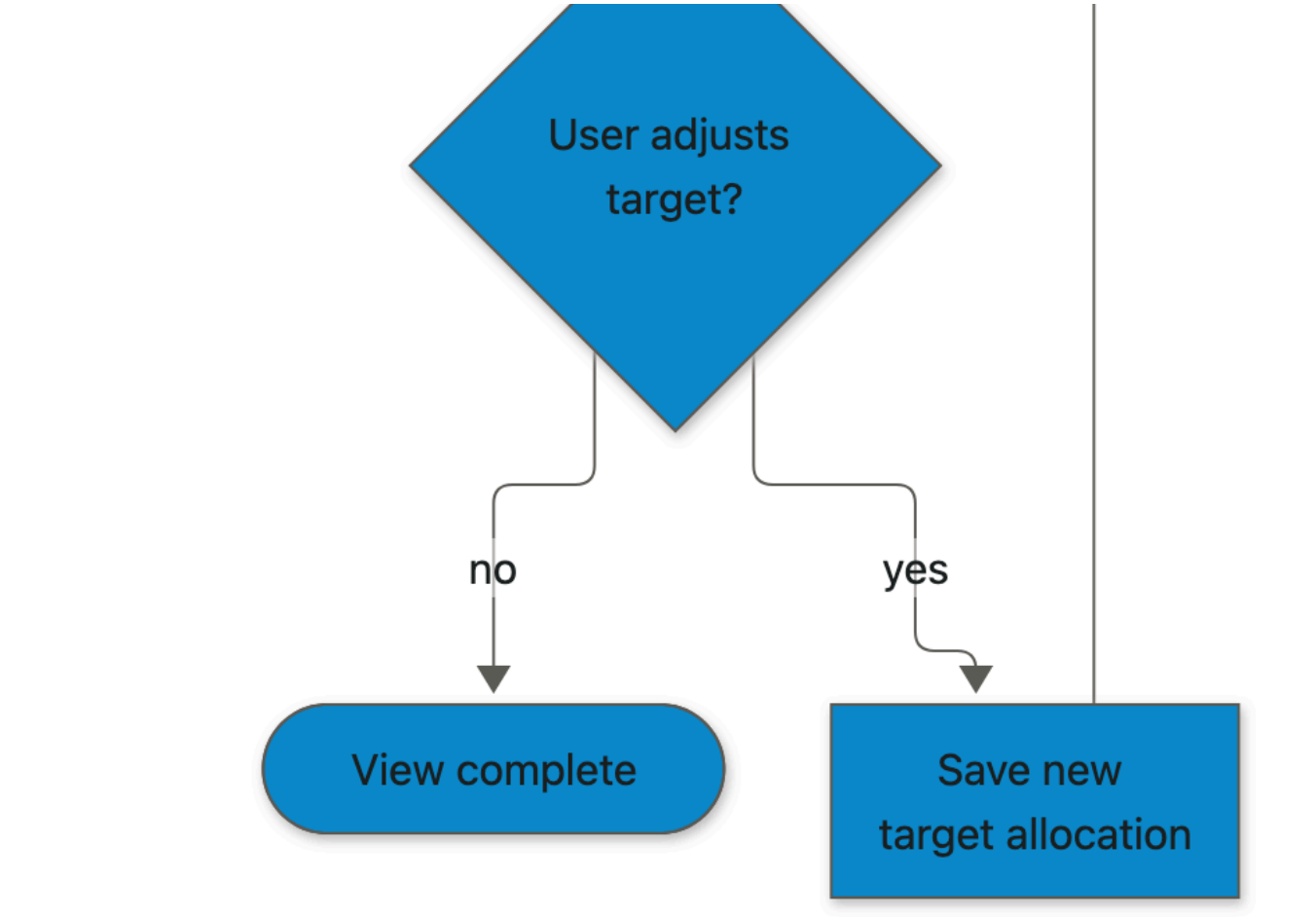
- The three-tier status (normal/caution/danger) reuses the product-wide status vocabulary — see design-system-spec.md § Financial semantics.
- Jurisdiction due dates, multipliers, and cumulative percentages are data-driven, so this view must render correctly for an arbitrary number of jurisdictions (PRD §5).
- **Redrawn pass 6:** v1 never moves money — there is no "User initiates payment?" button. The user pays at their own bank; it lands as an imported transaction with no counterparty; the user posts the GL entry, debiting the custodial tax-authority account. Dashboard/tax-panel copy says "post your payment," never "pay" or "transfer."
- **Addendum, pass 6:** two figures, both measured against the custodial account's balance but not against each other — **Pending liability = annualized tax to date – custodial prepaid balance** (what you'd owe net of prepayments, if filed today); **Gap = required payments to date (safe-harbor) – custodial balance** ("are you current with the authority"). Gap is never `required − pending`.

5.4 Custodial reconciliation, lots & allocation

Stories (PRD §4.5–4.7): *GL vs. custodial reconciliation, allocation vs. target. Source: flows/securities-lots-flow.md.* ***Pass 7:*** *"Securities" is gone as a nav item — lots are now a Custodial Accounts sub-card, GL vs. custodial is two nav items not a toggle, Allocation is its own page.*


Open Custodial Accounts for entity
Per-account cards: reported balance, link-health badge
Lots sub-card per security: pull-down shows lots, short/long/total gain per lot + summed
Reconcile GL balance against custodian-reported balance
Daily EOD price feed updates market value
Balances match within tolerance?

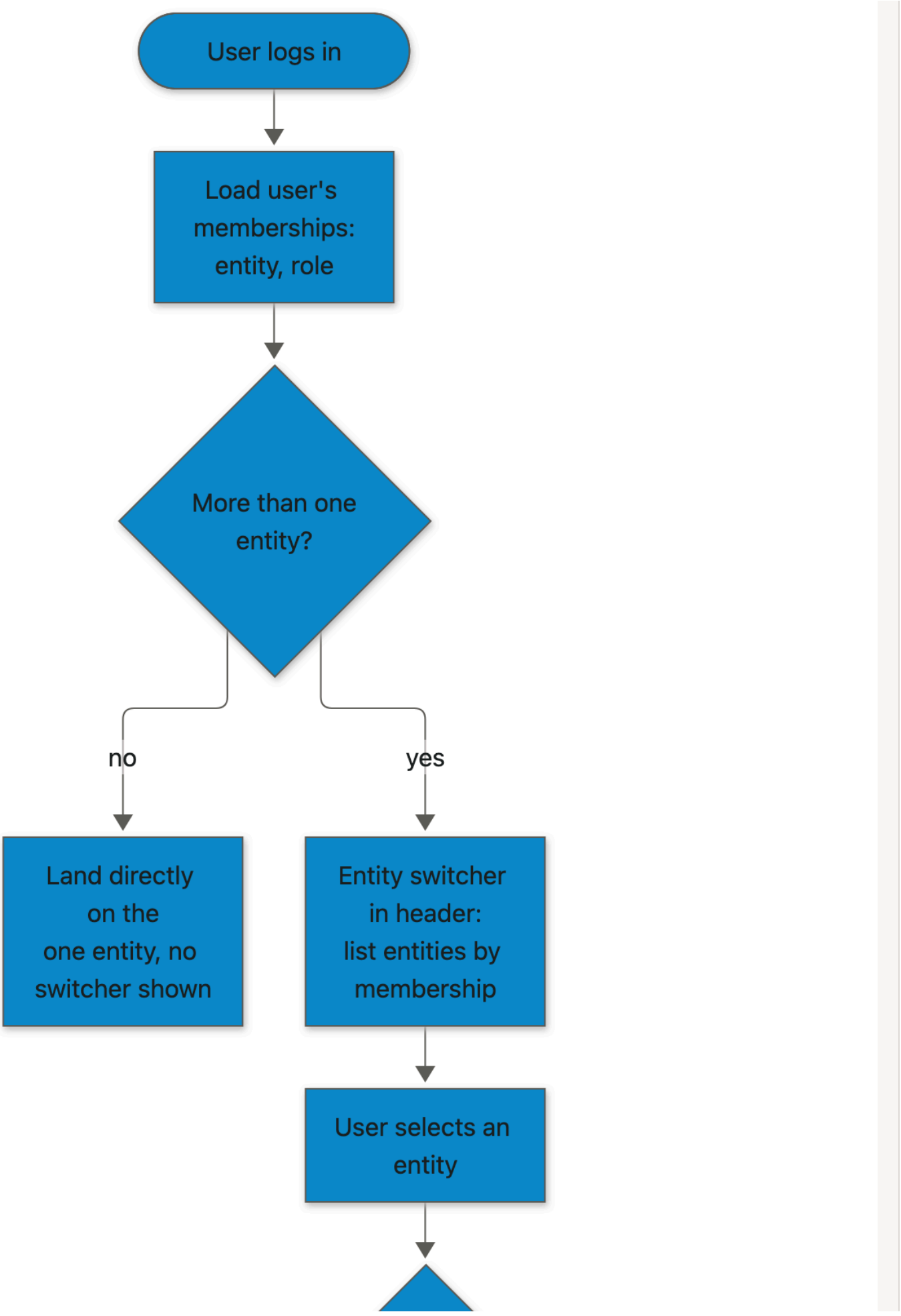

yes
no
Reconciliation:
clean
positive tier
Reconciliation:
break
danger tier,
flagged
General Ledger
account register
shows the
same balance,
GL side
Allocation:
actual vs.
target,
its own nav item

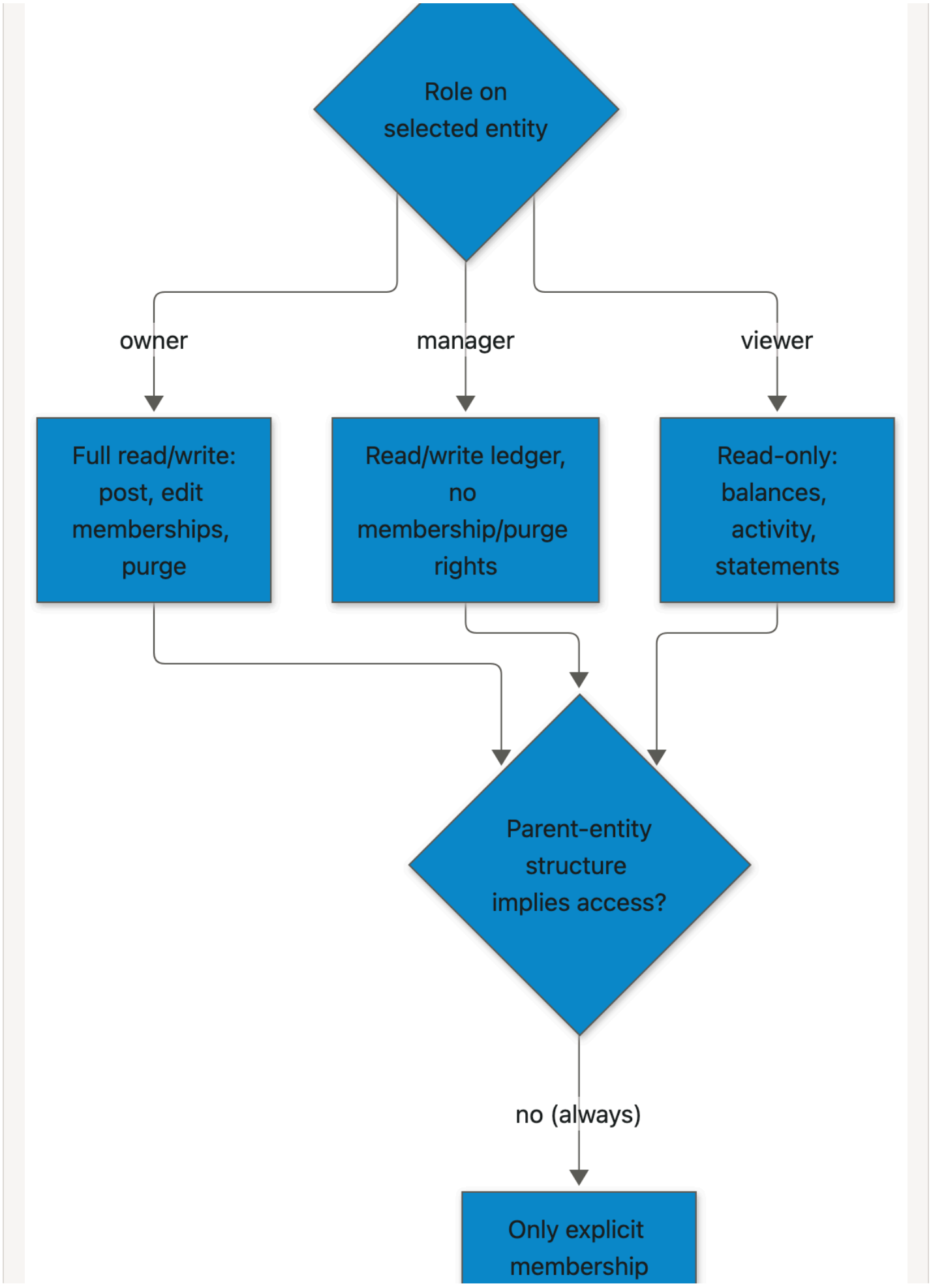


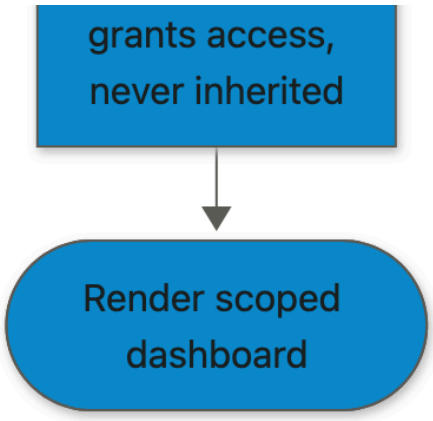
- **No toggle (pass 7):** General Ledger and Custodial Accounts are two separate nav items, not one screen behind a `Tabs` switch.
- Book-vs-market is implicit on the lots sub-card's own gain/loss figures, not a separate chart.
- A reconciliation break uses the danger tier (`--destructive`) and must surface on the Dashboard glance too.

5.5 Entity switch & membership access

Story (PRD §4.8): *owner/manager/viewer boundary. Source: flows/entity-membership-flow.md.*


User logs in
Load user's memberships: entity, role
More than one entity?
no
yes
Land directly on the one entity, no switcher shown
Entity switcher in header: list entities by membership
User selects an entity


Role on selected entity
owner
manager
viewer
Full read/write: post, edit memberships, purge
Read/write ledger, no membership/purge rights
Read-only: balances, activity, statements
Parent-entity structure implies access?
no (always)
Only explicit membership



- A Household's membership never transitively grants access to a member Person entity, or vice versa (PRD §5, hard requirement).
- A viewer never sees a write affordance rendered-then-disabled — write controls are omitted entirely, not shown-and-greyed.

6. Wireframes

*Low-fidelity layout of each key screen — structure before style. Assets in wireframes/. **Pass 7 (2026-10-02):** reorganized for the eight-item sidebar (design-system-spec.md § Sidebar information architecture) — rolling out across stages 2–5 of the same pass; items not yet rebuilt are marked pending rather than linked to a stale file.*

- Dashboard — per-entity financial health
- Transactions *(stage 2, done)* — three urgency-ordered accordion cards (Exceptions/Pending/Posted), Pending inbox built around the Plaid review/match workflow.
- General Ledger *(stage 3, done)* — chart-of-accounts tree; each account opens its own register page.
- Custodial Accounts *(stage 4, done)* — per-account cards, a lots sub-card (pull-down per security, short/long/total gains), and the `[+ New]` provider-item modal (aggregator/manual/file, discovered-account mapping, token refresh, unlink).
- Allocation *(stage 5, done)* — actual-vs-target, promoted out of the old Securities screen.
- Reports *(stage 5, done)* — Balance Sheet / Income Statement / Cash Flow, low fidelity; empty state until POLY-M5.
- Entities — unaffected by the sidebar rework
- Settings *(stage 5, done)* — batch-import schedule/options + app preferences.
- Home *(pass 4, corrected)* — public pre-auth landing page
- Login *(pass 4, new; corrected pass 6)* — split screen, centered form pane
- Membership setup *(pass 6, new)* — dashboard first-run / no-membership empty state, linked from flow 5.1
- Sidebar expand/collapse cues *(pass 4, decided pass 5)* — option A (chevron) chosen, B/C kept for the record; unaffected by the pass-7 item-list change

6.1 Operator surfaces

Not reachable from any in-app nav, not part of the eight-screen IA — operator-only, reached by SSH tunnel to the host.

- Admin *(pass 7 addendum, 2026-10-02)* — **placeholder, pending PRD/ARCH/SECURITY definition (POLY-81).** A plain status page (services, versions, DB/backup status, last sync, telemetry receiver state) + an "Administrative actions (TBD)" link list.

Gone as of pass 7 (stage 4): *`wireframes/securities.html` and `wireframes/import.html` are retired — their content is absorbed into Custodial Accounts (lots sub-card, provider-item modal) above.*

7. Styled Screens

High-fidelity screens that apply the design system to the wireframes, consuming `tokens.css` + `screen.css` — a visual regression reference and a head-start for `frontend-lead`. Prioritized by traffic (PRD §4 stories 1 & 2); remaining screens promote from wireframe fidelity as the design system stabilizes. ***Pass 7:*** *only Dashboard and Transactions get styled-screen fidelity for now, same traffic-priority rule as before — General Ledger, Custodial Accounts, Allocation, Reports, and Settings stay at wireframe fidelity until there's evidence a styled build is needed before Implement (judgment call, flagged in Open Questions).*

- Dashboard
- Transactions *(stage 2, done)*
- Home *(pass 4, new)*
- Login *(pass 4, new)*

8. Accessibility

Accessibility is a design responsibility, not a QA afterthought. Full table in design-system-spec.md § Accessibility.

Concern	Standard / approach
Color contrast	WCAG AA (4.5:1 text, 3:1 large/UI) — every token pair re-measured for the pass-4 neon-green rebrand, both modes; `--brand` deliberately fails against light surfaces (1.36:1, by design — never used there, see Foundations); no CVD simulation run yet (open item, now higher-priority given how central the brand hue is)
Color-alone signaling	Never — every gain/loss/status pairs color with a sign/icon/label
Keyboard	All interactive elements reachable & operable (shadcn default)
Screen readers	Semantic markup; labelled controls; delta sign readable from text content
Motion	Respect `prefers-reduced-motion` (policy not yet written)

9. Open Questions

Unresolved design decisions and assumptions that could be wrong. Batched to team-lead for relay to the Principal — not blocking.

- **Resolved 2026-10-11 (pass 10):** chart ramp re-hued from the green `--primary` to a gradient of `--brand-2`'s sky blue (Principal: "I'd like the chart tokens to be gradients of --brand-2 instead of --primary") — same light→dark ordering and L cadence as the superseded green ramp, every step still ≥3:1 against both `--background` and `--card` in its own mode (light floor 3.22:1 at `--chart-1`; dark floor 5.23:1 at `--chart-5`). The two-series comparison chart's series-2 accent flips to green `--brand` / `--primary` (was blue) so the two series stay distinguishable now that the ramp itself is blue. See design-system-spec.md § Foundations and tokens.html § 6 Charts for all ten hex values and contrast figures.
- **Resolved 2026-10-10 (pass 9):** refined again on the specific shadcn **sidebar-07** block (Principal review 6, "I'm still not happy with the sidebar...") — the sidebar is now a true floating card, rounded all 4 corners with a gutter on every side (`position: fixed` with inset `top` / `left` / `bottom`, not a hardcoded `height: 100vh`); the avatar popover opens to the RIGHT of the trigger, not above; the persistent/sticky header is gone entirely — renamed "Top row," it scrolls with the page and shares the content's own background token; the top row drops to panel-left icon + separator + breadcrumb (left) and entity selector + separator + a contextual "more" menu (right) — AI/search/notifications/settings-gear are removed, with Settings and Notifications proposed (not decided) as new avatar-popover items; every icon in the system is now Lucide, named per control in design-system-spec.md § Icon inventory. Applied to screen.css, wireframe.css, both styled screens, all nine sidebar-bearing wireframes, and sidebar-cues.html.
- **Resolved 2026-10-02 (pass 8):** app shell rebuilt on the shadcn Sidebar component's own pattern (Principal review 5) — sidebar now fills the viewport height (`position: fixed`, not `sticky`, fixing a real bug where a wireframe's own explanatory note pushed the sidebar below the visible viewport), brand moved to the sidebar's top item, an avatar-popover user menu (profile/preferences/theme/shortcuts/Log out) replaces the old bottom chevron, and Settings left the sidebar for a header gear icon (seven nav items remain). Header now starts right of the sidebar: expand/contract icon + breadcrumb left, entity selector/AI-icon/search/notifications/gear right — screens no longer repeat their title as an on-page heading. New § shadcn-svelte reuse map answers the Principal's reuse question directly. Applied to screen.css, wireframe.css, both styled screens, and all nine sidebar-bearing wireframes.
- **Resolved 2026-10-02 (pass 7, all 5 stages):** sidebar reworked to eight items per the Principal's interview (`temp/2026-10-02-sidebar-interview.md`) — Dashboard,

Transactions, General Ledger, Custodial Accounts, Allocation, Reports, Entities, Settings. "Securities" and "Import" are gone. Transactions rebuilt around the Plaid review/match workflow (expansion, Split, Group, a shared journal-entry modal); General Ledger opens to a chart-of-accounts tree with a per-account register page; Custodial Accounts gained a lots sub-card and a provider-item modal; Allocation, Reports (empty until POLY-M5), and Settings are new. See design-system-spec.md § Sidebar information architecture onward. **Judgment call:** only Dashboard and Transactions got styled-screen fidelity, matching the existing traffic-priority rule — flag if General Ledger, Custodial Accounts, or Allocation need a styled build sooner.

- **Resolved 2026-10-01 (pass 6):** `--warning` re-hued to a true orange with a dark ink (was brown-reading); light-mode chart ramp brightened; tokens.html added; Login wireframe corrected to match the centered styled screen; dashboard first-run/empty-state wireframe added (membership-setup.html); skeleton-vs-spinner explained in plain words; flow 5.2 reframed around the user-facing "Correct entry" action; flow 5.3 redrawn to remove the app-initiates-payment step.
- **Resolved 2026-09-30 (pass 5):** sidebar expand/collapse cue — option A (chevron) chosen; sidebar now full-height; header restructured to brand lockup + entity selector with an avatar cluster; login form pane centered — design-system-spec.md § Header, § Sidebar, § Login.
- **Avatar cluster overflow (pass 5):** the "+N" fold for 4th+ members is specified but not yet shown live in either reference screen (both currently have ≤2 members) — worth a quick visual check once a real multi-member entity exists.
- **Login's visual pane (pass 4):** built as a brand gradient, not a photo — no photography asset exists for this product. A real photo/illustration asset (in the style of the captured `dribbble` reference) would likely read stronger; flagging as a design-asset gap, not a layout question.
- No CVD (color-vision-deficiency) simulation run on the new palette yet — now higher priority given how central the brand hue is (recommended before lock, design-system-spec.md § Accessibility).
- **Superseded by pass 7:** the former Accounts screen's grouped-account-list + segmented-bar treatment was only built on the Dashboard styled screen — Accounts itself is now split into General Ledger and Custodial Accounts (both wireframe fidelity, stages 3–4); promote either the same way as a fast-follow if the gap matters before Implement.
- Native iOS/macOS token export format (kickoff §2.10) — not yet decided, non-blocking for web.
- `prototype/` throwaway UX prototype (kickoff §2.9) not yet built — confirm ownership/timing with team-lead.

10. Appendix

- PRD user stories & functional requirements: docs/PRD/index.html §4–5
- Kickoff record, frontend/design system decisions: docs/project_kickoff.md §2.9

10.1 FAQs

Q: How do I add review comments to this design doc?

A: Hand-edit `docs/DESIGN/comments.md` with `## §<section-id>` blocks, or run `/serve-docs DESIGN` and use the inline `+ Comment` widget. Then run `/refine-doc DESIGN`. See process/WORKFLOW.md → Doc review loop.

Q: Why is the design system in `docs/DESIGN/` and not in the app's source?

A: It's the design *deliverable* — the contract. During Implement, `frontend-lead` imports or derives the app's real stylesheets from `tokens.css` / `screen.css`.

Q: Where did `variants.css` go?

A: It was generated infrastructure for the `cairn` tracker tool's own theme switcher, never part of the product — removed from this directory (POLY-78 relocates its generator target the same way). See design-system-spec.md § Provenance & shared tooling.
